

Normal Chest X-ray: Expected Findings A normal chest radiograph shows clear lung fields bilaterally, with no areas of consolidation, effusion, or focal opacity. Expected features include:

- Symmetric lung expansion with normal lung markings (vascular structures visible, tapering appropriately toward the periphery)
 - Clear costophrenic angles (the sharp angle where the diaphragm meets the chest wall) -- blunting here can indicate pleural effusion
 - Normal cardiac silhouette size and position (roughly less than 50% of thoracic width on a standard PA film)
 - No mediastinal widening
 - Visible, intact bony structures (ribs, clavicles, spine) with no obvious fracture or lesion
- A "normal" reading does not rule out early-stage or subtle disease that may not yet be radiographically apparent -- clinical correlation remains important even for reassuring imaging findings, particularly if symptoms are present despite a clear film.